

Human Rights Legal Reference Guide

This document summarizes internationally recognized human rights laws using official United Nations and constitutional references. It includes real articles and legal provisions from the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR), the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR), and Fundamental Rights under the Constitution of India.

Human rights are legal and moral protections that apply to all human beings without discrimination. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948) established the global foundation for modern human rights law. Subsequent treaties such as the ICCPR expanded these protections into binding legal obligations. India also protects several fundamental human rights through Part III of the Constitution of India.

1. Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) – 1948

Article	Right / Legal Principle
Article 1	All human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights.
Article 2	Freedom from discrimination based on race, religion, nationality, sex, or status.
Article 3	Right to life, liberty, and personal security.
Article 4	Prohibition of slavery and servitude.
Article 5	Freedom from torture and cruel, inhuman, or degrading treatment.
Article 7	Equality before the law and equal legal protection.
Article 9	Protection against arbitrary arrest, detention, or exile.
Article 10	Right to a fair and public hearing by an independent tribunal.
Article 18	Freedom of thought, conscience, and religion.
Article 19	Freedom of opinion and expression.
Article 23	Right to work, equal pay, and favorable working conditions.
Article 26	Right to education.

2. International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR)

The ICCPR was adopted by the United Nations General Assembly in 1966 and entered into force in 1976. It legally binds participating states to protect civil and political rights. India ratified the ICCPR in 1979.

Article	Protected Right
Article 1	Right of peoples to self-determination.
Article 6	Right to life.
Article 7	Freedom from torture or cruel treatment.
Article 9	Right to liberty and security of person.
Article 14	Right to a fair trial.
Article 18	Freedom of religion and belief.

Article 19	Freedom of expression.
Article 21	Right to peaceful assembly.
Article 25	Right to participate in public affairs and elections.
Article 27	Rights of minorities to culture, religion, and language.

3. Fundamental Rights under the Constitution of India

Part III of the Constitution of India guarantees Fundamental Rights enforceable by courts. These rights are considered essential for democracy, equality, and personal liberty.

Constitutional Article	Provision
Article 14	Equality before law and equal protection of laws.
Article 15	Prohibition of discrimination on religion, race, caste, sex, or place of birth.
Article 16	Equality of opportunity in public employment.
Article 19	Freedom of speech, assembly, association, movement, residence, and profession.
Article 21	Protection of life and personal liberty.
Article 21A	Right to free and compulsory education for children.
Article 23	Prohibition of human trafficking and forced labor.
Article 24	Prohibition of child labor in hazardous employment.
Article 25	Freedom of conscience and religion.
Article 32	Right to constitutional remedies before the Supreme Court.

4. Child Labour and Human Rights Protection

Child labour protections are recognized both internationally and under Indian constitutional law. Key legal protections:

- UDHR Article 25 recognizes the right to protection of childhood.
- ICCPR supports protection of minors through state obligations.
- Constitution of India Article 24 prohibits employment of children below 14 years in hazardous industries.
- The Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986 regulates and prohibits child labour in India.

Official Legal Sources

- United Nations – Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR)
- Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) – ICCPR
- Constitution of India – Part III Fundamental Rights
- National Human Rights Commission (India)

This guide is educational and informational in nature. It summarizes authentic legal provisions from internationally recognized human rights instruments and Indian constitutional law.